

Ticket D-Saster

A Proposal from the Product Owner

Allowing you to meet your favorite bat-eating rockstars since Jan 1982.

Who we are

We have been putting fans in front of stages since January of 1982.

We are not engineers. We sell nights people remember for the rest of their lives. What follows is not a specification. It is what we live every day, as a project proposal for you to drive.

The night everything went wrong

A rainy day last November, we ran the on sale for the *most brutal deathcore singer in history*: **Sabrina Carpenter**. Within the first minutes, **one hundred thousand fans** were on the site *at the same time*. Here are some of the issues we face currently:

- The site slowed to a crawl, then died. Fans saw error pages, infinite spinners, and dropped sessions.
- A sad but true story, two different fans showed up at the venue holding “valid” tickets for **Row C, seat 14**.
- Some fans paid and never got a seat. Some got charged twice. Some watched the payment screen spin until their hold expired and the seat went to someone else.
- One re-seller, Jeremy, spoke up in a forum that if you killed the JS scripts at the checkout page, **the seat-hold countdown froze with it**, so they could keep seats hostage for hours while reselling them on the sidewalk.

Our staff has been paranoid every Friday since.

What we dream of

A platform where a fan finds a show, picks a seat, pays, and walks into the venue with confidence at every step. And where the people running the shows can see what is happening while it happens.

A Day in the life of a fan

Walk with me through a Fan (Roxanne's) evening:

1. Roxanne hears a rumor that her favorite reggaeton with guitars band (Slipknot) is touring. She opens our site and **browses what is coming up**. She looks for shows. sometimes by band name, sometimes search “concerts in Merida in December”, sometimes just by her favorite venue.
2. She opens the event and sees **the seat map as it is right now**, what is free, what is taken, and what each seat costs.
3. She picks a seat, and for a few **minutes** that seat is **locked reserved while she checks out**, nobody can snatch it, and she cannot keep it forever either.

4. On hot sale nights, when every seat is being held, or when the site is reaching a peak of concurrent buyers, Roxane don't encounter an error page but instead is able to join a **place in the queue**, that indicates her how many users are before her waiting to buy a ticket, keeping an even flow of fans toward checkout.
5. Once she locks on a ticket, she's able to pay. This must be the most **boring** step of the whole story: quick, no drama, no double charges, and if her card fails, she finds out immediately, before the lock is gone.
6. Her ticket arrives, and **it works at the gate. Every time.** No duplicated seats, no two tickets pointing the same seat, QR maps correctly to the seat and name of the holder.

A Day in the life of an organizer

Organizers are our other customers, and they pay the bills, let's think of the case of the representatives of the best Speedcore rave performers: **Fuerza Regida** goes through:

- They **publish their event**: pick a registered venue, set the date, and define seating categories and prices per category on top of the venue's seat map.
- They choose **the exact moment tickets go on sale**. Friday at 2 minutes to midnight is a ritual sacred in this industry, the doors must open exactly then, not when the system feels ready.
- While the show sells, they want to **watch it happen**, how many seats are gone, how fast, and how the event is performing overall.

A Day in the life of a venue owner

None of these nights happen in a Parking Lot. Before a single ticket exists, somebody must take us to the stage. Venue owners are our partners. think of the owner of **Estadio Azteca**, that cozy little underground spot in CDMX:

- They come to us once and say: *"I own this place. Here is where it is, and here is its seat map."* They **register their venue**: name, location, and the seat map as it physically exists sections, rows, seats.
- Venues are living things: Fire smoke closes the north tunnel; a new VIP section appears. They **keep their seat map current**, so every future show sells the venue as it really is.
- The map is drawn **once**, by the people who own the building. Organizers host their shows on top of it; nobody should have to redraw Estadio Azteca a hundred times a month.

Numbers we live with

- A hot on sale brings **100,000 fans at the same time**. That is not a once-a-year record, that is any Friday with a big name.
- We hold about **100 new events every month**. Each event with description, images, seat layout, weighs roughly **100 KB**.
- Seat holds are short, a handful of minutes: **the clock must be ours, not in browsers**. If the Wi-Fi blinks users can restore its session and the remaining time, if the user goes away and never leaves the page even through killing JS Scripting the counter should still end and free the seat.